PRINTABLE PARTY GAME

Christmas Murder Mystery Party

The Stolen Star of Hollyridge Lodge: a cozy whodunit for 8 players

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Host guide and setup
- 2 invitations per sheet
- 9 clue cards in 3 rounds
- Sealed solution page
- Timeline and host script
- 8 character sheets
- Detective Notes sheet
- 8 name tags and 2 awards

16 PAGES

PRINTABLE · INSTANT DOWNLOAD

START HERE

Host Guide

Everything you need to run the party. Read this page and the next one, then you are ready.

HOW THE GAME WORKS

Eight guests each play a character at a snowed-in lodge on Christmas Eve. The lodge's famous gold Star was stolen from the top of the tree during a 12-minute blackout. Over three rounds, guests read their lines, share alibis, hear 9 clue cards and spill secrets. At the end everyone names the thief.

Only one guest can be the thief, and the clues prove it two separate ways. Every other player has an alibi a clue card can confirm. Family friendly: nothing is hurt but a mantel clock.

WHAT TO PRINT

- [ ] **Invitations** page 4, 2 per sheet
- [ ] **8 character sheets** pages 5 to 12, one each
- [ ] **9 clue cards** page 13, cut apart
- [ ] **Detective Notes** page 14, one per player
- [ ] **Solution** page 15, fold and keep sealed
- [ ] **Name tags, awards** page 16, cut apart

BEFORE THE PARTY: SETUP CHECKLIST

1. 2 to 3 weeks out: send invitations and give each guest a character. Any guest can play any role; costume ideas are on each sheet.
2. 1 week out: send each guest ONLY their own character sheet. One sheet says YOU ARE THE THIEF (the sealed solution says whose): give it to a guest who enjoys a fib.
3. Party day: cut out the 9 clue cards and stack them by round (R1, R2, R3). Fold the solution page and keep it in an envelope.
4. Optional props: a gold paper star on a small tree, a stopped clock showing 7:14, a bag of flour, candles for the blackout.

HOST TIPS

- ★ You can play too: take Ivy or Rupert, read the clue cards out yourself, and act surprised at the end.
- ★ Fewer than 8 guests? Drop a pair: Noelle and Felix, or Jasper and Dash. Their clue cards still clear them.
- ★ Guests may bend the truth about their secrets until Round 3, but never about a clue card.
- ★ Keep things moving: about 25 minutes per round is plenty. Dinner fits between Rounds 1 and 2.

HOST

Party Timeline and Host Script

Read the lines in italics out loud. Times are from when guests arrive.

TIME	STEP	WHAT TO DO
0:00	Guests arrive	Hand out name tags and character sheets (if not sent ahead). Serve drinks.
0:10	Read the opening	Host reads the opening on this page out loud. Everyone reads their Round 1 part.
0:15	Round 1: Meet the suspects	Read Round 1 clue cards (C1, C3, C9). Guests mingle, introduce themselves, ask questions.
0:45	Dinner and Round 2	Read Round 2 clue cards (C4, C5, C6) between courses. Everyone gives their alibi.
1:15	Round 3: Secrets out	Read Round 3 clue cards (C7, C8, C2). Secrets come out. Last questions.
1:35	Accusations	Each player fills in a Detective Notes sheet and names the thief.
1:45	The reveal	Host reads the solution page. The thief takes a bow. Hand out awards.

OPENING: READ THIS OUT AT 0:10

Christmas Eve, Hollyridge Lodge, high in the snowy hills. A storm has shut the road, so eight people are stuck together for dinner. At 7:00 the owner, Ivy Hollister, raised a toast to the Hollyridge Star: a hand-made gold and crystal tree topper that has crowned the lodge tree since 1952. At 7:08 every light in the lodge went out. At 7:20 they came back on, and the top of the tree was bare. Nobody has left. The Star is still somewhere in this lodge, and one of you took it.

ROUND 1

Read clue cards C1, C3 and C9 aloud. Each guest reads their Round 1 part, then everyone mingles.

ROUND 2

Read clue cards C4, C5 and C6. Alibis come out. Ask: 'Who can prove where they were at 7:14?'

ROUND 3

Read clue cards C7, C8 and C2. Secrets come out. Then say: 'The Star is still in this lodge. Who took it?'

Accusations and the reveal

Hand out Detective Notes (page 14) and allow 5 minutes. Then read the sealed solution (page 15) and give out the 2 awards.

SEND 2 TO 3 WEEKS AHEAD

Invitations

Print, cut on the dashed line, and fill in by hand. Two per sheet.

YOU ARE INVITED TO A

Christmas Murder Mystery

The Stolen Star of Hollyridge Lodge

Christmas Eve. A snowed-in lodge. The lights go out for 12 minutes, and the famous Star vanishes from the tree. Come in character, and find the thief before the buns go cold.

YOUR CHARACTER _____

DATE AND TIME _____

PLACE _____

RSVP TO _____

Dress the part. Costume ideas are on your character sheet.

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DATE AND TIME _____

PLACE _____

RSVP TO _____

Dress the part. Costume ideas are on your character sheet.

CHARACTER 1 OF 8 · OWNER OF HOLLYRIDGE LODGE

Ivy Hollister

WHO YOU ARE

You inherited the lodge from your grandfather and you love every creaky board of it. Guests call you warm; staff call you strict. The Star is the lodge's pride and you built tonight's whole dinner around showing it off.

COSTUME

Velvet dress or blazer, pearls, velvet heels, a big ring of keys.

YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

The lodge is behind on its bills. Last month you raised the Star's insurance to $60,000. It looks bad, and you know it.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

At 7:05 you went to the office to take a call from the bank on the landline. You stayed on the phone in the dark until about 7:25.

ROUND 1 — Welcome everyone. Tell the room the Star's story: made by hand in 1952, bought by your grandfather from a glassmaker in the valley. Say you want it back tonight, no questions asked.

ROUND 2 — When asked, give your alibi: the bank call in the office. Admit the lodge has money trouble, but say you would never sell the Star.

ROUND 3 — If the insurance comes up, admit it, then point out that a claim takes months and would not save the lodge by spring. You care more about the Star than the money.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Jasper, how much do you still owe me?*
- ★ *Rupert, what did you offer me for the Star yesterday?*
- ★ *Clem, where did you learn to bake like your grandmother?*

CHARACTER 2 OF 8 · SKI INSTRUCTOR

Jasper Pike

WHO YOU ARE

You teach the guests to ski and you are the loudest laugh in any room. You are charming, a little reckless and always short of cash. You were standing right by the tree at the 7:00 toast.

COSTUME

Ski sweater, wool hat, goggles on the head, chunky ski boots.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

You owe Ivy $2,000 from a loan last winter. You and Dash were secretly fixing your snowmobile so you could slip into town tomorrow and buy Ivy a thank-you gift.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

From 7:06 to 7:30 you were in the garage with Dash working on the snowmobile by headlamp. The garage camera runs on a battery.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself with a joke. Say you saw the Star sparkle at 7:00 and nothing after that because the lights went out.

ROUND 2 — Give your alibi: the garage with Dash. Do not say why you were fixing the snowmobile yet.

ROUND 3 — Confess the loan and the gift plan. Say the garage camera will clear you and Dash both.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Marigold, why do you have a drawing of the Star in your notebook?*
- ★ *Felix, what is in the box in your bag?*
- ★ *Clem, did you hear anything from the kitchen?*

CHARACTER 3 OF 8 · HEAD COOK

Clem Baxter

WHO YOU ARE

You run the lodge kitchen and your cinnamon buns are famous. You are cheerful, busy and good at keeping people fed and talking. YOU ARE THE THIEF. Your late grandmother made the Star by hand in 1952 and sold it to the lodge for almost nothing to pay a doctor's bill. You promised her you would bring it home.

COSTUME

Apron, rolled sleeves, a dusting of flour, a wooden spoon, kitchen clogs.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

At 7:08 you flipped the main switch on the panel in the back hall, slipped into the dark drawing room, stood on the piano bench, untwisted the wire and lifted the Star. You bumped the mantel clock on the way out. The Star is hidden in the flour bin. You flipped the power back on at 7:20.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

Your story (a lie): you were in the kitchen pulling the cinnamon buns out of the oven at 7:15. Stick to it. Never admit the oven is electric unless someone proves it.

ROUND 1	Be friendly and helpful. Offer everyone a bun. Say the Star was the prettiest thing in the lodge and you hope it turns up.
ROUND 2	Give your oven alibi: buns out at 7:15. Point gently at Rupert: he wanted the Star badly. Do not mention your grandmother.
ROUND 3	If someone proves the power was off, say the buns were just resting in a warm oven. Keep pointing at Rupert and the insurance. You may lie; you may not destroy a clue card.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Rupert, you offered a fortune for the Star. Did Ivy say no?*
- ★ *Ivy, how much is the Star insured for?*
- ★ *Jasper, you were closest to the tree at 7:00, weren't you?*

CHARACTER 4 OF 8 · ANTIQUE DEALER AND GUEST

Rupert Vane

WHO YOU ARE

You buy and sell rare antiques and you can price a teacup from across a room. You came to the lodge to ski and slipped on the slope on Tuesday. Your right hand is in a splint and you cannot grip a thing with it.

COSTUME

Tweed jacket, bow tie, reading glasses, leather loafers, one arm in a sling.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

Yesterday you offered Ivy $40,000 for the Star and she said no. You were angry about it at breakfast and half the lodge heard.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

When the lights went out you felt your way to an armchair in the hall and waited. Nobody saw you, and you cannot prove it.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself. Say the Star is the finest piece of 1950s glass you have ever seen and that you are a collector, not a thief.

ROUND 2 — Admit you were alone in the dark hall. Admit the $40,000 offer only if someone asks about it.

ROUND 3 — Hold up your splint. Ask how a man with one working hand could untwist wire on top of a tree in the dark.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Clem, the kitchen is next to the back hall. Did you hear the panel click?*
- ★ *Ivy, why raise the insurance last month?*
- ★ *Noelle, what were you recording?*

CHARACTER 5 OF 8 · LODGE SINGER

Noelle Winters

WHO YOU ARE

You sing by the fire every night of the season. You are dreamy, kind and always humming. You and Felix slipped into the library before dinner to work on a new Christmas song.

COSTUME

Sparkly sweater or dress, a scarf, snow boots, a songbook.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

This is your last season at the lodge. A record label in the city offered you a contract and you have not told Ivy yet.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

From 7:09 to 7:19 you and Felix recorded a voice memo of your song in the library, by candlelight. Both your voices are on it, with the time stamp.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself and hum a few notes. Say you love this lodge and the Star means Christmas to you.

ROUND 2 — Give your alibi: the library with Felix, recording. Say you will play the memo if anyone doubts you.

ROUND 3 — Tell Ivy about the record contract. Say leaving is hard, and you would never steal from her on the way out.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Marigold, which room were you in during the blackout?*
- ★ *Dash, who flipped the lights back on?*
- ★ *Clem, did the buns burn when the power went off?*

CHARACTER 6 OF 8 · LODGE HANDYMAN

Dash Moreno

WHO YOU ARE

You fix everything at Hollyridge: pipes, lifts, lights, snowmobiles. You are quiet, steady and you notice details. You know the lodge has no gas: every light and every oven runs on electricity.

COSTUME

Flannel shirt, tool belt, work gloves, heavy work boots.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

You sneak a slice of pie from the kitchen every night and Clem has never noticed. Tonight you also helped Jasper with his snowmobile without asking Ivy.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

From 7:06 to 7:30 you were in the garage with Jasper. The battery camera on the garage wall shows you both.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself. Say the blackout was strange: no storm damage, and the lights came back all at once at 7:20.

ROUND 2 — Give your alibi: the garage with Jasper. Say you will check the smart panel log if the host lets you.

ROUND 3 — Point out that the panel log says the main switch was flipped BY HAND. Ask who was close to the back hall panel.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Clem, how do you bake buns with no electricity?*
- ★ *Rupert, can you even hold a screwdriver with that hand?*
- ★ *Ivy, who else knew where the panel was?*

CHARACTER 7 OF 8 · TRAVEL WRITER

Marigold Finch

WHO YOU ARE

You write for a big travel magazine and every hotel is nervous around you. You are sharp, curious and you take notes on everyone. You booked Room 4, upstairs.

COSTUME

Smart coat, beret, notebook and pen, heeled boots.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

Your notebook has a careful drawing of the Star. You planned a magazine story called 'The Star of the Hills' and wanted it to be a surprise for Ivy.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

At 7:02 you went up to Room 4 to change shoes. The door lock runs on a battery and logs every key card. You stayed in your room until 7:31.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself. Say you are here to write about the lodge and you take notes on everyone, so behave.

ROUND 2 — Give your alibi: Room 4, from 7:02. If someone finds the drawing, say it is for an article.

ROUND 3 — Explain the magazine story and show the drawing. Ask the host to check the Room 4 lock log.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Jasper, why are you so short of money?*
- ★ *Clem, what did you bake tonight and when?*
- ★ *Felix, what were you hiding in that box?*

CHARACTER 8 OF 8 · IVY'S NEPHEW

Felix Hart

WHO YOU ARE

You are Ivy's favorite nephew and the lodge's best (and only) guitar player. You are funny, nervous and you hate secrets, which is a problem tonight.

COSTUME

Bright holiday sweater, sneakers, a guitar or a gift box.



YOUR SECRET (KEEP IT UNTIL ROUND 3)

In your bag is a box with a copy of the Star you had made in town as a surprise for Ivy, so the real one could be kept safe. It looks very suspicious tonight.

YOUR ALIBI FOR 7:08 TO 7:20

From 7:09 to 7:19 you were in the library with Noelle, playing guitar on her voice memo. Both your voices are on it, with the time stamp.

ROUND 1 — Introduce yourself. Say you grew up with the Star on this tree and you cannot imagine Christmas without it.

ROUND 2 — Give your alibi: the library with Noelle. Get jumpy if anyone mentions your bag.

ROUND 3 — Open the box and show the copy. Tell Ivy it was meant to be her present. The real Star is still missing.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- ★ *Rupert, where exactly were you sitting in the dark?*
- ★ *Clem, can I see the oven?*
- ★ *Dash, who knew how to switch the power off?*

9 CLUES

Clue Cards

Cut apart. The host reads them out by round: R1 = C1, C3, C9; R2 = C4, C5, C6; R3 = C7, C8, C2.

C1 · ROUND 1 ★

The Stopped Clock

The mantel clock in the drawing room was knocked to the floor and stopped at 7:14. The piano bench was dragged under the tree. Whoever took the Star was in the drawing room at 7:14.

C3 · ROUND 1 ★

The Panel Log

The smart panel in the back hall says the main switch was flipped OFF by hand at 7:08 and back ON at 7:20. No storm fault. The lodge has no gas: the lights, the heat and the kitchen oven are all electric.

C9 · ROUND 1 ★

The 6:45 Group Photo

Shoes in the photo: Ivy, velvet heels. Jasper, ski boots. Clem, kitchen clogs (smooth and flat). Rupert, heeled loafers. Noelle, snow boots. Dash, work boots. Marigold, heeled boots. Felix, zigzag sneakers.

C4 · ROUND 2 ★

The Phone Bill

The lodge phone company's call record: the office landline was on a call from 7:05 to 7:25, to the bank. Landlines work in a blackout. Ivy was in the office the whole time.

C5 · ROUND 2 ★

The Garage Camera

The battery camera on the garage wall shows Jasper and Dash working on a snowmobile by headlamp at 7:14, and the whole time from 7:06 to 7:30. Neither leaves the frame.

C6 · ROUND 2 ★

The Voice Memo

A phone recording from the library, time stamped 7:09 to 7:19: Noelle singing a new Christmas song and Felix on guitar. Both voices, start to finish, no gaps.

C7 · ROUND 3 ★

The Room 4 Lock Log

The battery door lock on Room 4 logs Marigold's key card IN at 7:02 and OUT at 7:31. Room 4 has no other door, and the window is frozen shut.

C8 · ROUND 3 ★

The Star's Mount

The Star sits on a brass spike, held by a wire twisted tight. The wire was untwisted, not cut: that takes two hands. A doctor's note says Rupert's right hand has been in a splint since Tuesday.

C2 · ROUND 3 ★

The Print on the Bench

The velvet piano bench under the tree holds one shoe print: a smooth, flat sole with no heel and no tread, and a light dusting of white powder in it.

ACCUSATION SHEET

Detective Notes

One per player. Fill it in as the clues come out, then name the thief.

SUSPECT	WHERE AT 7:14?	PROOF (CLUE CARD)	SHOES	RULED OUT?
Ivy Hollister				☐
Jasper Pike				☐
Clem Baxter				☐
Rupert Vane				☐
Noelle Winters				☐
Dash Moreno				☐
Marigold Finch				☐
Felix Hart				☐

CLUES I WANT TO REMEMBER

MY ACCUSATION

THE THIEF IS

THEY LIED ABOUT

THE CLUE THAT PROVES IT

WHY THEY DID IT

DETECTIVE'S NAME

DO NOT PEEK

The Solution

Host only. Fold this page and keep it sealed until everyone has made an accusation.

The thief is Clem Baxter, the head cook.

READ THIS OUT

Lights on, everyone. The clock on the floor tells us when: 7:14, in the dark drawing room. The bank's phone record puts Ivy in the office. The garage camera clears Jasper and Dash. Noelle and Felix sang together on a time-stamped memo. Marigold's lock log keeps her in Room 4. Rupert could not untwist that wire with one good hand. That leaves one person with no proof at all: Clem Baxter. Clem says the buns came out of the oven at 7:15, but the panel log shows the power was off from 7:08 to 7:20, and every oven here is electric. And the print on the bench? Smooth, flat, no heel, no tread, dusted with flour. Kitchen clogs.

SUSPECT	CLEARED BY	CARD
Ivy	Office phone call 7:05 to 7:25	C4
Jasper	Garage camera 7:06 to 7:30	C5
Dash	Garage camera 7:06 to 7:30	C5
Noelle	Library voice memo 7:09 to 7:19	C6
Felix	Library voice memo 7:09 to 7:19	C6
Marigold	Room 4 lock log 7:02 to 7:31	C7
Rupert	Right hand in a splint: cannot untwist wire	C8
Clem	Oven alibi broken: power off 7:08 to 7:20	C3 + C2

WHY CLEM DID IT

Clem's grandmother made the Hollyridge Star with her own hands in 1952 and sold it to the lodge for almost nothing to pay a doctor's bill. Clem promised her the Star would come home one day. Tonight, in the dark, Clem tried to keep that promise.

HOW IT ENDS

Check the flour bin. The Star is wrapped in a tea towel, not a scratch on it. Ivy, moved by the story, makes Clem an offer: from now on the Star spends every other Christmas on the Baxter family tree. Clem says yes, and the buns are on the house.

CUT APART

Name Tags and Awards

Cut out a name tag for each guest. Hand out the 2 awards after the reveal.

HELLO, I AM

Ivy Hollister

Owner of Hollyridge Lodge

HELLO, I AM

Jasper Pike

Ski Instructor

HELLO, I AM

Clem Baxter

Head Cook

HELLO, I AM

Rupert Vane

Antique Dealer and Guest

HELLO, I AM

Noelle Winters

Lodge Singer

HELLO, I AM

Dash Moreno

Lodge Handyman

HELLO, I AM

Marigold Finch

Travel Writer

HELLO, I AM

Felix Hart

Ivy's Nephew

★

Master Detective

for the sharpest mind at Hollyridge Lodge

AWARDED TO

★

Best in Character

for the performance of the evening

AWARDED TO



You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations